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Git Recovery

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What is Git Recovery?

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Git recovery means getting back lost commits, branches, or files.

Git keeps a record of recent changes so you can undo mistakes-even after a reset or delete.

When to Use Git Recovery

Use Git recovery when you:

- Accidentally delete a branch or file
- Reset your branch to a previous commit and lose changes
- Need to recover lost commits or changes

Recover Lost Commits with `git reflog`

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Example: Show Reflog

```
[user@localhost] $ git reflog
e56ba1f (HEAD -> master) HEAD@{0}: commit: Revert "Just
52418f7 HEAD@{1}: commit: Just a regular update, defini
9a9add8 (origin/master) HEAD@{2}: commit: Added .gitigr
81912ba HEAD@{3}: commit: Corrected spelling error
3fdaa5b HEAD@{4}: merge: Merge pull request #1 from w3s
836e5bf HEAD@{5}: commit: Updated readme for GitHub Bra
...
```

Find the commit hash you want to recover from the list.

Restore a Deleted Branch

If you deleted a branch but the commits are still in reflog, you can recreate it:

Example: Restore a Branch

```
[user@localhost] $ git checkout -b branch-name <commit-hash>
Switched to a new branch 'branch-name'
```

This brings back the branch at the commit you specify.

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Recover a Deleted or Changed File

If you deleted or changed a file and want to get it back, use `git restore`:

Example: Restore a File

```
[user@localhost] $ git restore filename.txt
```

This brings back the file from the latest commit.

Recover from a Hard Reset

If you used `git reset --hard` and lost commits, you can use the reflog to find and restore them:

Example: Undo a Hard Reset

```
[user@localhost] $ git reflog
e56ba1f (HEAD -> master) HEAD@{0}: commit: Revert "Just
52418f7 HEAD@{1}: commit: Just a regular update, defini
9a9add8 (origin/master) HEAD@{2}: commit: Added .gitigr
81912ba HEAD@{3}: commit: Corrected spelling error
3fdaa5b HEAD@{4}: merge: Merge pull request #1 from w3s
836e5bf HEAD@{5}: commit: Updated readme for GitHub Bra
...
[user@localhost] $
```

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This puts your branch back to the state it was in at that point.

Tips & Best Practices

- Regularly commit your changes to avoid losing work
- Use `git reflog` to find lost commits
- Use `git restore` to recover deleted or changed files

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